

**SOUTH AFRICA****Capital cities:**

Pretoria/Tshwane, Cape Town, Bloemfontein

Area: 471,008 sq miles (1,219,912 sq km)

Population: 45,000,000

Official languages:

9 African languages, English, Afrikaans

Major religions:

Christian 68%, traditional beliefs 29%, Muslim 2% Hindu 1%

Government: Multiparty democracy

Currency: Rand

Adult literacy rate: 86%

Life expectancy: 46 years

People per doctor: 1,667

Televisions: 125 per 1,000 people

SWAZILAND

Capital city: Mbabane

Area: 6,704 sq miles (17,363 sq km)

Population: 1,100,000

Official languages:

Siswati, English

Major religions:

Christian 60%, traditional beliefs 40%

Government: Absolute monarchy

Currency: Lilangeni

Adult literacy rate: 81%

Life expectancy: 44 years

People per doctor: 5,000

LESOTHO

Capital city: Maseru

Area: 11,720 sq miles (30,335 sq km)

Population: 1,800,000

Official languages:

English, Sesotho

Major religions:

Christian 90%, traditional beliefs 10%

Government: Democracy

Currency: Loti

Adult literacy rate: 81%

Life expectancy: 38 years

People per doctor: 10,000

Televisions: 25 per 1,000 people

SOUTH AFRICA

In 1994 SOUTH AFRICA moved from minority rule by its white population to majority government under the multiracial control of the African National Congress (ANC). Since 1948, the South African government had practiced apartheid, keeping the different races apart and restricting power to white people. South Africa became isolated from the rest of the world and violence between the races grew. After the election of the ANC leader Nelson Mandela as president, the apartheid system was dismantled and South Africa has resumed full international relations.



THE TOWNSHIPS

As part of South Africa's apartheid policies, black workers and their families were excluded from the main towns and forced to live in specially built townships a great distance from their work. The biggest and most famous of these townships is Soweto, home to more than 1 million people. Every day, black workers leave Soweto and commute for many hours on overcrowded buses and trains to work in the mines and factories of neighboring Johannesburg.

Grapefruit



Lime

Lemon

FRUIT GROWING

South Africa is a major exporter of food, thanks to its warm, dry climate and fertile soil. Citrus fruits, apples, and grapes are grown and then exported around the world. South Africa is also known for its fine wines.

**NELSON MANDELA**

Jailed in 1964 as a senior member of the ANC, Nelson Mandela (shown above with F. W. de Klerk) spent 26 years in prison until he was released in 1990. This was a result of President de Klerk's decision to legalize black freedom groups, with a view to ending apartheid. Under Nelson Mandela's leadership, the ANC won political power in 1994, and Mandela became the first black president of South Africa.

**THE NDEBELE**

South Africa is a multiracial country, with many different ethnic groups and 11 official languages. One group, the Ndebele, are known for their distinctive houses, which are brightly decorated in strong, geometric shapes. Women are responsible for the upkeep of the huts and repaint the outer walls each spring.

THE GOLDEN CITY

South Africa has three capital cities, with the administration in Pretoria/Tshwane, the courts of law in Bloemfontein, and the parliament in Cape Town. However, the financial and industrial heart of South Africa is Johannesburg (shown right), known as "the golden city." Gold mines deep beneath the surface have created enormous wealth, encouraging the development of a sprawling industrial area manufacturing cars, textiles, and high-tech and heavy engineering products.

